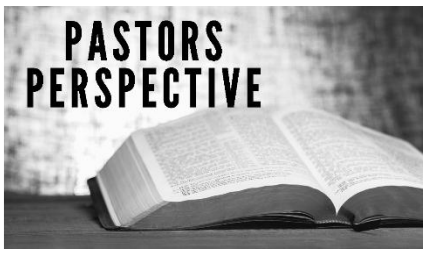
August 2026 Volume 30, Issue 8

THE ROCKY HOCK ANCHOR

The Mission of Rocky Hock Baptist Church is to magnify Christ and make disciples of all people.



"For GOODY'S Sake!"
A Lesson about Eternity Hidden in Plain Sight along Highway 32

Philippians 3:20-21 - *"For our conversation is in heaven; from whence also we look for the Saviour, the Lord Jesus Christ: Who shall change our vile body, that it may be fashioned like unto his glorious body, according to the working whereby he is able even to subdue all things unto himself."*



If you've ever traveled north on Highway 32 towards the state line… you've probably noticed a little store with giant orange letters across the front that read: **G-O-O-D-Y'S.**

I'll never forget the first time I heard about this store. One of our middle school moms — I think it may have been Stacey Virginia — was giving me directions to a ballgame. She said — "Go past Goody's and it'll be on the left. You can't miss it."

At that point in time, "Goody's" was just a name to me. However, as I drove past it that day… I stopped in my tracks. I knew those letters. Those big orange letters were the same ones that hung over a department store I used to frequent as a child in Murphy, NC. Those stores eventually closed, and I think the only one left is in Sanford, NC. Needless to say, seeing those bright orange letters was a major throwback. And I suppose that whoever owns that store at the corner of 32 and Center Hill, must've procured their signage from one of those department stores from my neck of the woods.

Back when I was little, we used to go to Goody's a lot. Mom would take us there to buy school clothes. But what I remember most wasn't the clothes. *It was actually the floors*.

Those floors were so smooth — almost like polished marble. They were the slickest floors anywhere! Slicker than Walmart. Slicker than the Grocery Store. Always spick and span. In the mind of a kid during the mid-2000's, these floors were absolutely perfect. Especially if you happened to be wearing a pair of shoes called "heelys" (see image).



If you're from my generation (or parented someone from my generation), you probably remember them. They looked like ordinary tennis shoes… but hidden in the heel was a secret compartment that held a little wheel. All you had to do was pop the wheel in, lean back, and push off… and suddenly you weren't walking anymore — you were gliding! And there was no better place to let loose on some "heely's" than at Goody's. The aisles were long and the floors were slick. And me and my friends were probably clocking 12 mph on a single go. On the outside, the shoes looked normal. Everyone thought they were just another pair of shoes. But hidden inside was something that transformed the way you moved. It was almost like a superpower. The moment that wheel dropped into place… you went places – *fast!*

(continued on page 2)

(continued from page 1)

Where am I going with this? *Glad you asked.* Over the past month, our church family has walked through 7 funerals together. We've done a lot of talking about Heaven and the wonderful promise that "to be absent from the body" is "to be present with the Lord."

Sometimes I wonder if the joy of that moment — when we finally get to Heaven — will feel a little bit like putting on those old heelys. One second, you're just walking by faith… the next thing you know, you're moving in a way you never could before! Gliding across those streets of gold and *rolling* right up to the feet of Jesus! It's going to be a glorious transformation, indeed. No more suffering. No more fear or disappointment. Just an overwhelming feeling of joy as you arrive in the presence of the One who paid it all.

Needless to say… every time I pass that little Goody's store, I think about gliding across those slick floors without a care in the world. But I also think about Heaven, too. I think about what it's gonna to be like to put off this ole flesh and take up immortality. To be transformed at the feet of Jesus! What a Savior! What a hope!

… The next time you drive past Goody's, I hope you'll think about that, too.

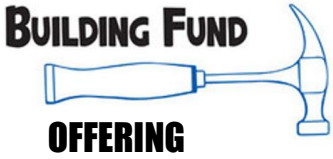
Pastor Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor

BAPTIST MEN



The Baptist Men's Breakfast will be on Sunday, August 16th at 7:30 AM in the Special Function Room. Gentlemen, please join us for food, fellowship, and a devotion!

Building Fund Offering - Sunday, August 16th: This offering will be taken at the doors following the 11:00 AM Worship Service.



Join us on Monday, August 17th at Ballard's Bridge Baptist Church for the Region 1 Mission Rally. The rally highlights the variety of opportunities NC Baptists have to be involved in missions across our state, nation, and world. The meal will begin at 5:45 PM, followed by the program from 6:50 – 8:30 PM. Please register **one week prior to the event** by emailing Tina Holder at tholder@ncbaptist.org or by calling 919-459-5596.



Saturday, August 22nd – Senior Adults Cook-out from 11 AM – 2 PM in the Special Function Room

Menu includes hamburgers, baked beans, chips, and a dessert, as well as tea and water. We will also have a devotion. More details will be in upcoming bulletins, and sign-up sheets will be placed in the usual locations soon.

Sunday, August 30th – 5th Sunday Missions Offering for Operation Christmas Child

This offering will help defray the cost of shipping the shoeboxes. Plan now to give generously to our annual OCC mission project!

THE YOUTH ZONE

WHAT IS A FOLLOWER?

From: devotions4teens.com

Background Story: Jesus has been healing the sick everywhere. People keep following Him everywhere He goes for all sorts of reasons. In this story, He is teaching in a home.

Read: Luke 5:17-26

17 One day while Jesus was teaching, some Pharisees and teachers of religious law were sitting nearby. (It seemed that these men showed up from every village in all Galilee and Judea, as well as from Jerusalem.) And the Lord's healing power was strongly with Jesus. 18 Some men came carrying a paralyzed man on a sleeping mat. They tried to take him inside to Jesus, 19 but they couldn't reach him because of the crowd. So they went up to the roof and took off some tiles. Then they lowered the sick man on his mat down into the crowd, right in front of Jesus. 20 Seeing their faith, Jesus said to the man, "Young man, your sins are forgiven." 21 But the Pharisees and teachers of religious law said to themselves, "Who does he think he is? That's blasphemy! Only God can forgive sins!" 22 Jesus knew what they were thinking, so he asked them, "Why do you question this in your hearts? 23 Is it easier to say 'Your sins are forgiven,' or 'Stand up and walk'? 24 So I will prove to you that the Son of Man has the authority on earth to forgive sins." Then Jesus turned to the paralyzed man and said, "Stand up, pick up your mat, and go home!" 25 And immediately, as everyone watched, the man jumped up, picked up his mat, and went home praising God. 26 Everyone was gripped with great wonder and awe, and they praised God, exclaiming, "We have seen amazing things today!"

Big Idea: Not everyone who follows Jesus, follows Jesus

In this passage, we see different groups of people "following" Jesus physically. But were all the people who followed Jesus actually followers of Jesus? Let's take a look at each group to see application to our own life.

1- Religious People: This group of "religious leaders" were not there to learn from Jesus. They grew up in the Jewish faith and had developed prideful hearts thinking they knew everything. Similarly, growing up in church does not make a person a follower of Christ. Church can be part of a person's culture or family tradition. But a Christian (or follower of Christ) isn't someone who has a religious tradition of attending church. A Christian is a person who has recognized they are a sinner in need of a Savior and chooses to put their faith and trust in Jesus.

2- Crowd: Jesus was a celebrity. Before TV, social media, and YouTube, people flocked to see Jesus' miracles. They were there for the experience, the feeling, and the hopeful message. But even as they saw Jesus' mighty works, many of these "followers" had no revelation that this man was the Messiah. We can go to youth group or conferences, scream delight at Christian bands, and post Bible verses to Instagram. But do these things alone make us a true follower of Jesus? Jesus said in Matthew 13:20-21 that some "hear the word and at once receive it with joy. But since they have no root, they last only a short time. When trouble or persecution come because of the word, they quickly fall away." Being a follower of Jesus requires us to get real… away from the lights and the emotions, where we pursue to know Jesus and follow Him in "Spirit and in truth" (John 4:24).

3- Friends: The friends who came with the sick man were there for only one purpose… their friend needed an encounter with Jesus, and they recognized that Jesus was the only solution. There is a longing in a follower of Christ to bring the lost, the broken, and the sick to the feet of Jesus. This longing arises from the simple truth that we were once that broken man on the mat without hope. We looked up from our place of brokenness to the face of the Messiah to find forgiveness and restoration. This truth creates a longing to share from the love and grace we received.

In response, today let's take time to pray that we would be followers of our Savior. That we wouldn't just follow in proximity for the experience, but that we pursue our Savior to know Him and make Him known.

Takeaway Verses: Matthew 7: 13 - 14

"Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction, and many enter through it. But small is the gate and narrow is the road that leads to life, and only a few find it."

Song For Today: "I Will Follow Jesus / Lace Up Your Boots" – Circuit Rider Music, featuring Eniola Abioye

Baptist Women

Choosing Joy: Together on Mission

From Tarheel Talk, Spring 2026, by Barbara Hill, President WMU NC

As I sit in my office and reflect on joy—choosing joy and living out everything joy—I am drawn back to Paul's words in Philippians 2:2: *"Make my joy complete by being likeminded, having the same love, being one in spirit and of one mind."*

This verse is more than a beautiful sentiment. It is a blueprint for a joyful, unified mission. It paints a picture of what the church can be when we link arms for the sake of the gospel. And it is exactly what WMU of North Carolina has been helping churches and believers do for more than a century—cultivating joyful unity around the Great Commission.

The first word of the Great Commission is often translated "**Go**," or more accurately, "**as you are going**." It reminds us that living on mission is not limited to a place or a moment. It is about living out the love of Christ in our everyday lives—right where God has placed us. In our homes. In our workplaces. In our communities.

The mission of WMU North Carolina flows directly from this calling. Woman's Missionary Union of North Carolina is a missions organization whose purpose is to challenge, prepare, and equip Christian believers to be radically involved in the fulfillment of the Great Commission. Everything we do—every resource, ministry, and opportunity—is rooted in helping believers faithfully live out Christ's command as they are going, wherever God has placed them. WMU North Carolina equips believers to live this out through three primary ministry categories: Missions Education, Compassion Ministries, and Leadership Development.

Missions Education

Missions education is for everyone—from preschoolers to adults. WMU provides age-appropriate resources designed to help believers become disciples of Jesus who live on mission. WMU offers tools and curriculum that engage people at every stage of life (Mission Friends Guides, GA's Adventures, Missions Mosaic, etc.). Missions education is about preparation and purpose—equipping you to live on mission and inviting others to walk alongside you.

Compassion Ministries

WMU compassion ministries create opportunities to meet both physical and spiritual needs around the world. Ministries, such as Red Boxes, Prison Retreats, Military Wives/Moms Camp, International Kids Camps, Pure Water, Pure Love, WorldCrafts, and Christian Job Corps, touch lives with the love of Christ in tangible ways. Compassion ministries allow us to be the hands and feet of Jesus—bringing hope where it is desperately needed.

Leadership Development

Leadership development is woven into everything WMU does. From online courses to print and digital resources to inperson training—known as **Abound**—WMU NC offers women and teen girls meaningful opportunities to discover and grow their leadership skills and spiritual gifts. WMU North Carolina believes leadership looks different for each person. Whether you are leading a small group, mentoring the next generation, or learning how to integrate missions into daily life, WMU equips you with tools to lead faithfully where God has called you.

If you would like to join one of our Baptist Women's Circles and be a part of this group of believers who serve together joyfully, please contact Belva White for more information.

Deacon Team of the Week

8/2/26 – 8/8/26
Carroll Evans, Ruston Howell, Danny Lewis

8/9/26 – 8/15/26
Lee Bass, Allen Nixon, Ellis Tynch

8/16/26 – 8/22/26
Wayne Bunch, David Spruill, Paul Ward

8/23/26 – 8/29/26
J. C. Forehand, Scott Noble, Mike Evans

8/30/26 – 9/5/26
Russell Byrum, Matthew Evans, Phil Smith

August Deacon Greeters

Senior Adult Building: Paul Ward

Sanctuary Main Entrance: Roger Smith

Connecting Corridor: Allen Nixon

Multi-Purpose Main Entrance: Carroll Evans

August Ushers

Lee Jordan, Ellis Tynch, Paul Ward,
Aundra Harrell, Jay Parrish, Butch Byrum

August Offering Team

Chris Turner (Lead), Matthew Evans,
J. C. Forehand, Ruston Howell,
Allen Nixon, Allen Peele

August Counting Committee

Aundra Harrell, Mary Louise Phelps,
Phil & Rene` Smith, Ellis Tynch

Stewardship

Sunday Attendance:	SS	AM	PM
6/28/26:	151	379	58
7/5/26:	126	215	Fireworks
7/12/26:	154	254	77
7/19/26:	148	235	53

Wednesday PM Attendance:

7/1/26:	60
7/8/26:	No Services due to VBS
7/15/26:	62
7/22/26:	70

Edenton-Chowan Food Pantry

The request from RHBC this month is:

Nutri Grain Bars



SERVE NC

ONE CHURCH. ONE MONTH.
ONE MISSION.

This August, let's **BE THE CHURCH** beyond our walls. Individuals, Sunday School classes, youth, kids, families, and ministry groups are invited to pray about—and put into action—a service project that blesses our community and reflects the love of Christ.

PRAY
Ask God to show you a need.
He will give you the vision.

SERVE
Step out in faith and serve someone in Jesus' name.

SHARE
Make a lasting impact.
Show the love of Christ in action.

Make your plan. Make a difference.
LET'S SERVE NC—TOGETHER!

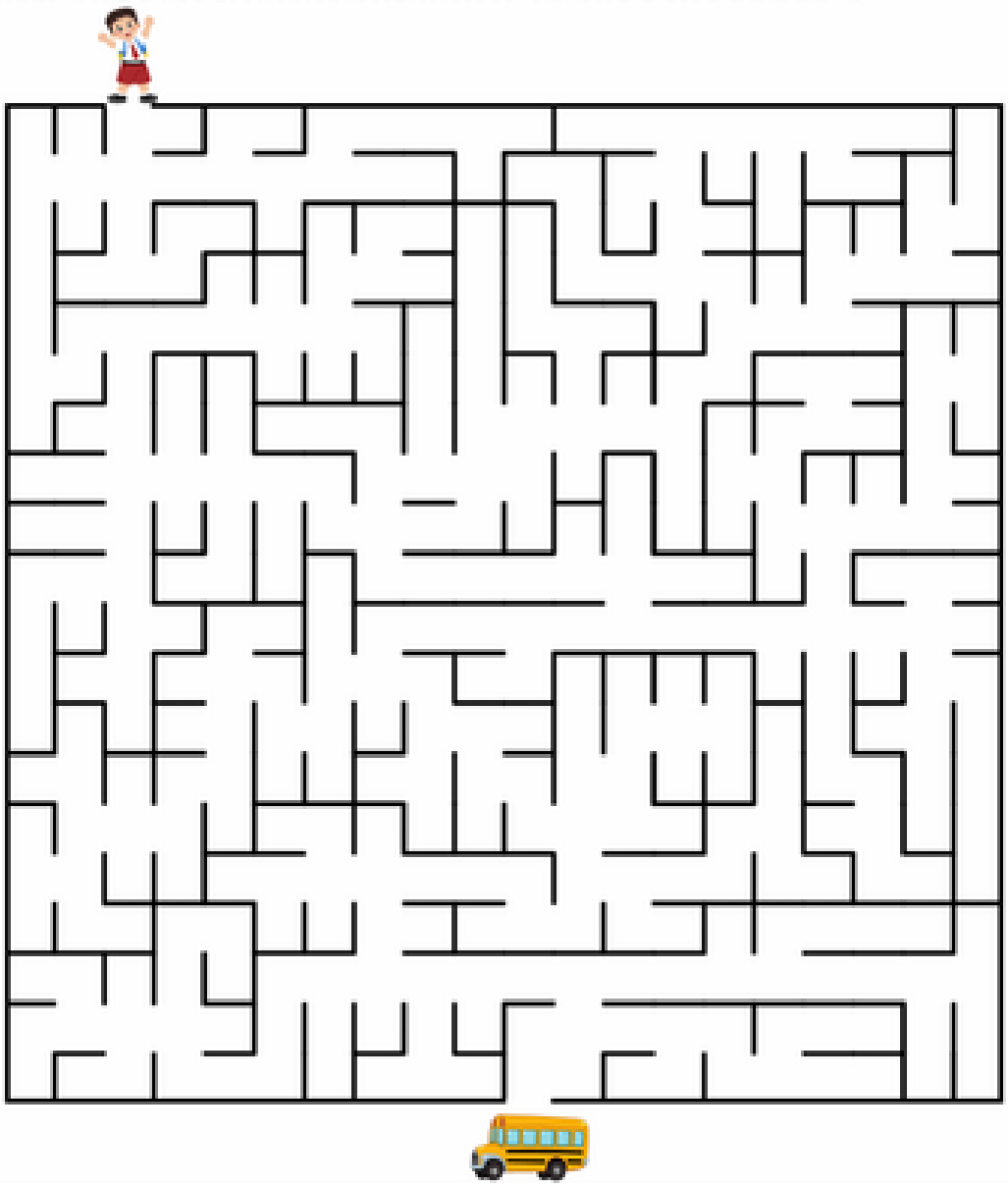
ALL OF AUGUST
Plan your project and make it happen anytime during the month!

REGISTER TODAY
Let Linda in the church office know about your group's service project.
Let's show our community what Jesus looks like.

"For even the Son of Man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many." MARK 10:45

CHILDREN'S PAGE for children of all ages

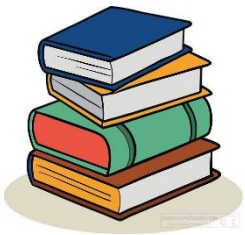
HELP THE STUDENT FIND HIS WAY TO THE SCHOOL BUS!





Sunday, August 23rd – Back to School Sunday at the 11:00 AM Worship Service

Join us for our Annual "Back to School" Sunday on August 23rd at 11 AM as we pray for our students and school staff as they prepare to return for the 2026-2027 school year.





Our next Church Conference will be on Wednesday, August 26th at 7 PM in the Sanctuary, followed by Prayer Meeting, if time permits. All Committees / Ministry Teams should submit a written report (via email to lbunch@rhbce.org or by dropping it off at the Church Office) no later than 12:00 Noon on the date of Conference.

Youth and Children will follow the regular Wednesday night schedule:
6:45 PM – Vertical Student Ministry (6th - 12th Graders) in the Youth Suite (meal provided), 7 PM - GA's (Girls in 1st - 5th Grades) – GA's Room beside foyer, RA's (Boys in 1st - 5th Grades) – RA's Room upstairs, and Mission Friends (3 - 5 year olds) - 2 year olds Classroom.

Rocky Hock Baptist Church
113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, NC 27932

ADDRESS SERVICE REQUESTED

NON-PROFIT
ORGANIZATION
US POSTAGE PAID
EDENTON, NC
PERMIT NO. 127



Check us out on the web at www.rhbce.org

Sundays:

9:45 AM - Sunday School for all ages

11:00 AM - Morning Worship (Nursery & Children's Church available for 3 year olds - 5th Grade); Worship Online at www.rhbce.org, our Facebook page, vimeo, and YouTube

6:00 PM - Evening Worship - ***"DEEP DIVE"*** - Adults in Sanctuary, Youth in Youth Suite, Children in Gym

Wednesdays:

6:45 PM - Vertical Student Ministries (VSM) - Middle & High School Youth - Youth Suite; Girls in Action (1st-5th Grade Girls) - GA's Room, beside foyer; Royal Ambassadors (1st-5th Grade Boys) – RA's Room, upstairs (meal provided for GA's & RA's in Special Function Room during the school year)

7:00 PM - "**WORSHIP** *Seeds*" for Adults - Sanctuary; Mission Friends (3-5 year olds) - 2 year olds Room

---

Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor, trogers@rhbce.org
Office: 252-687-2086 Cell: 706-994-2652

Allen Nixon, Deacon Chair Cell: 252-312-7966

Linda B. Bunch, Administrative Assistant
lbunch@rhbce.org Office: 252-221-4133

Deborah Long, Custodian
Mary Jo Bass, Treasurer
Trey Bass, Security
Donna Peele, Pianist

Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON